Hermes Kanban

Multi-Agent Profile Collaboration for Hermes Agent

A durable, profile-aware work-queue architecture for coordinating heterogeneous agent workloads across research, operations, and engineering

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Abstract

This document specifies **Hermes Kanban**, a multi-agent collaboration layer for the Hermes Agent framework. It defines a durable, SQLite-backed task board shared across named agent *profiles*, allowing heterogeneous agents—researchers, editors, engineers, persistent digital-twin assistants—to collaborate asynchronously on long-lived work without the lifecycle fragility of in-process subagent swarms.

We compare the proposed architecture against three contemporary systems: Cline Kanban's worktree-per-task board, Paperclip's persistent-agent company orchestrator, and NanoClaw's failed in-process agent-team SDK. We further contextualize the design against Google's April 2026 Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform, which splits the agentic stack between a governance-oriented control plane and a velocity-oriented execution plane. Hermes Kanban deliberately stays at the execution plane, with governance expressible as user-space profiles and plugins rather than kernel features.

The specification covers: a minimal SQLite schema (tasks, links, comments, events), a dumb cron-driven dispatcher with atomic claims, eight canonical collaboration patterns, four user stories spanning research / scheduled operations / persistent digital twins / coding, a first-class orchestrator profile pattern (addressing the common "my orchestrator does the work itself" failure mode), an optional single-column multi-tenant extension that lets one specialist fleet serve many business contexts, and an implementation plan organized as eight independently shippable pull requests. The kernel requires no changes to `run_agent.py`, no new core tools, and no tool-schema expansion on any API call.

Status: DESIGN ONLY. No implementation accompanies this document.
Target audience: Hermes maintainers and contributors; design-review participants.